

Leo Taggart

ACT I / Before the murder

Your history with Sterling

Sterling fed you several flattering claims for an earlier profile that you later discovered were exaggerated. He threatened to cut off access if you corrected them.

What you are hiding

You are preparing a correction that will also make you look embarrassingly credulous. Do not volunteer this immediately. In Act II, protect it unless interrogation forces your hand; in Act III, reveal it if you need to defend yourself.

Your objectives

- Protect your private complication until you decide disclosure helps you.
- Use your public relationships to trade information rather than waiting for clues to come to you.
- Ask at least two people where they were during the poisoning window.

What you know about other guests

- Nadia is preparing a major investigation involving Sterling's collection.
- Beatrice remembers the museum's early Voss acquisitions very differently from the current polished story.

Notes / Who will you speak to first?

ACT II / After Sterling dies

Follow your assigned branch. Keep it private. If you are the murderer, the innocent branch is a cover story you may claim.

IF INNOCENT

Nadia's notes and Maya both place you in the dining room during the key minutes.

IF MURDERER

You entered at 6:46 for a quote, poisoned the cordial, and left your distinctive press pencil beneath the service table.

ACT III / Evidence update

Your sealed evidence pair contains Cards A and B. If you are INNOCENT, secretly submit Card B. If you are the MURDERER, secretly submit Card A. Put the unused card away.

FINAL STATEMENT / Read only if called

IF INNOCENT

I repeated flattering claims Sterling fed me in an old profile, and I am preparing a correction that will make me look gullible. He threatened to cut off access if I ran it. Nadia's notes place me with her while the poison was added. Bad journalism is not murder, though tonight has made the distinction unusually comforting.

IF MURDERER

Sterling built part of his local legend by feeding me stories I was too pleased to verify. He planned to punish me for correcting them. I went in for one last quote, poisoned his cordial, and left my old press pencil beneath the tray. I wanted to revise the record. I became the headline.

Investigation notes
